

Some personal effects have the potential to bring pests or disease into Australia and need to be declared.

The list below is designed to assist you identify which goods may be of biosecurity concern and may require cleaning or treatment prior to release. If this is not possible, the items may need to be destroyed or exported at your expense.

Category	Items
Animal equipment including, but not limited to:	
Artefacts/Furnishings/Ornaments/Souvenirs including, but not limited to:	
Camping equipment including, but not limited to:	
Clothing including, but not limited to:	
Farm goods, vehicles and motorised equipment including but not limited to:	
Festive decorations including, but not limited to:	
Garden equipment, garden furniture and tools including, but not limited to:	
General items including, but not limited to:	
Kitchen - all food and pantry items including, but not limited to:	
Kitchenware including, but not limited to:	
Miscellaneous goods including	
Sporting goods and playground equipment including, but not limited to:	Sporting goods or equipment that have been in contact with fresh water must be dry on arrival.
Toys including, but not limited to:	
Wooden items including, but not limited to:	

[expand all]

What should I do if bringing in unaccompanied personal effects?

The following checklist is designed to help returning residents or new residents of Australia to prepare their goods prior to packing, so clearance delays and costs can be minimised once the goods arrive in Australia.

- Consult the following web pages:
 - Department of Home Affairs - [Sending your personal belongings to Australia](#).
 - Department of Agriculture, Fisheries and Forestry - [Moving to Australia or importing personal effects/household goods](#).
 - [Biosecurity Import Conditions system \(BICON\)](#) to search for import conditions for specific items.
- Department of Home Affairs -
- Complete your Unaccompanied Personal Effects Statement (B534) and declare goods of concern.
 - The [B534 form](#) is located in a [variety of languages](#).
 - You or your agent should record the box numbers for any declared risk items so they can be easily located for the inspection. This will reduce your inspection time and costs.
 - Failure to declare risk items on the B534 can lead to prosecution under Australian legislation.
- The
- Clean all risk items that you wish to transport to Australia to ensure they are not contaminated with animal or plant material, insects or soil. This includes:
 - outdoor toys; such as sandpits, pedal cars, toy trucks
 - outdoor furniture, outdoor pots, statues and water fountains
 - lawn mowers, garden equipment/ornaments, shovels
 - footwear - shoes, boots, football boots (pack them in the same boxes)
 - pushbikes, motorbikes and quad bikes
 - sporting equipment including gym/exercise weights
 - barbecues, oven grills and cook tops
 - camping equipment
 - vacuum cleaner bag - ensure it is empty and clean
 - rubbish bins
 - animal cages and bedding, fish tanks
 - carpets, rugs, mats - ensure they have been vacuumed
 - horse equipment (check BICON for import conditions)
- Clearly record what is in each box on the packing list.
 - When you or your removalist record items on the list, include what the goods are made from; for example metal bed frame, wooden chair(s), plastic picture frames, cane basket.

- Number the packing boxes and match the numbers on your packing list.
 - It is better not to use second hand boxes or bags that have previously been used to carry animal and plant material and soil; for example, fruit and vegetable cartons, meat boxes, egg cartons and fertiliser bags.

Tips for wooden items and goods including plant material

- Timber / wooden furniture: check for small holes or frass/shavings under the items as this may indicate wood borers are present. If live timber pests are found on arrival, the furniture will require treatment at your expense.
- Heat bags: check to see what they are filled with and record this on the packing list. Treatment may be required if they are filled with seeds or plant material.
- Decorations, artefacts, ornaments, picture frames, photo albums, handmade paper, pot pourri, dried flowers: check for plant material; for example, pine cones, vines, moss, flowers, leaves, seeds and bark, as it may require treatment or destruction at your expense.
 - Christmas decorations containing plant material are one of the most common items volunteered for destruction at the owner's expense.

Tips for other goods

- Foods: check import conditions on the department's BICON system. Some foods are permitted but others may be prohibited or require treatment.
- Pet food and medicine: check import conditions on BICON. They may require an import permit.
- Animal skins or rawhide items: check import conditions on BICON. They may require treatment.
- High-risk plant products: check the [khapra beetle urgent actions](#) webpage for a list of products that are not permitted.

Source: https://www.agriculture.gov.au/biosecurity-trade/travelling/moving-immigrating/personal_effects